

Josh's DCS ICT PD Learning Architecture

A trainer-the-trainer guide for Josh, AI tutors, human teachers and assessors

Built from Josh's DCS role, uploaded PD plans, skill graphs, quiz data, and learning feedback

The core verdict

The best way for Josh to learn ICT is not passive course-watching. It is a contextual mastery system: short study blocks, retrieval practice, strict feedback, DCS-based scenarios, spaced repetition, and visible evidence - all inside the Level 1 boundary currently set at DCS.

Use this if you are...	What to do with it
Josh	Follow the weekly rhythm, 12-week sprint, error log, and DCS scenario prompts.
AI teacher	Use the question format, marking rubric, spaced review cycle, and upper-Bloom task bank.
Human teacher/mentor	Anchor coaching in Josh's actual DCS devices, tickets, and role boundary.
Manager or supervisor	Read the guardrails and evidence pack; it is quiet PD, not a request for extra access.

1. Executive plan

what Josh should actually do

The recommended PD architecture

Josh should run a **12-month contextual mastery apprenticeship** around DCS Level 1 support. It should be free, low-risk, visible in evidence, and tied to the school's actual endpoints, classroom technology, identity tools, networks, printers, and support tickets.

One sentence strategy

Learn A+ as the backbone, Cisco Networking Basics as the gap-filler, Microsoft Learn AB-900/M365 as the school-systems context, and Endpoint Security as the safety layer - but convert every learning block into a DCS scenario, mini-checklist, flashcard, or ticket-improvement note.

Priority	PD lane	Why this is the right fit	Evidence produced
1	CompTIA A+ Core 1 and Core 2 via Professor Messer	Best broad foundation for endpoint support, hardware, Windows/macOS/Linux basics, mobile, printers, networking, troubleshooting and communication.	Topic notes, quiz scores, scenario answers, better escalation notes.
2	Cisco Networking Basics	Targets Josh's biggest recurring gap: DNS, DHCP, ports, cabling, Wi-Fi, VLAN logic and basic network diagnosis.	Networking glossary, subnet/firewall practice, NetAcad progress.
3	Microsoft Learn AB-900 / M365 admin concepts	DCS runs on Microsoft 365 concepts: identity, groups, Teams, SharePoint, OneDrive, access, governance and security.	M365 object map, offboarding checklist, identity/access flashcards.
4	Cisco Endpoint Security / Cybersecurity Essentials	Supports child-safe data handling, confidentiality, malware response, phishing, MFA, patching and endpoint risk.	Security scenario log, safe escalation notes.
5	Optional later: AZ-900, Jamf 100, Google IT Support	Only add if relevant to live work, if free/funded, or if iPad/cloud work becomes central.	Decision point, not immediate workload.

Do not confuse learning with production access

Practise in notes, Packet Tracer, home lab, Microsoft Learn sandboxes, or AI scenarios. Do not practise in AD, Entra, Intune, SharePoint, Teams policies, firewalls, switches, or production systems unless Paul or the assigned IT lead explicitly gives you the task.

2. DCS role context

the training must serve the actual job

What the role actually requires

The formal DCS IT Support Assistant role centres on maintaining ICT assets and infrastructure, operational IT support, ICT desk support, data management assistance and daily operational tasking. It includes endpoint PC work, software installation, troubleshooting, tickets, staff/student incidents, 1st and some 2nd level support, user creation/security, staff point-of-need training, documentation, and change-management awareness.

Formal role need	Learning response	What success looks like
Endpoint PCs, software, new PCs, troubleshooting	A+ hardware, operating systems, deployment concepts, drivers, display, storage and printers	Faster first-pass diagnosis and cleaner escalation notes.
Tickets from phone/email/walk-up	Troubleshooting method, ticket writing, communication drills	Every escalation includes symptom, device, room, network, steps tried and current state.
1st and some 2nd level support	A+ first, then networking/M365 concepts; no production admin practice without assignment	Confident L1 plus safer questions for L2 tasks.
User creation/security	M365/Entra concepts, groups, MFA, least privilege, offboarding	Can explain the sequence and risks before touching accounts.
Staff training at point of need	Worked examples, micro-guides, teach-back, classroom technology scenarios	Short, useful guides that reduce repeat friction.
Change management for multi-user issues	Scenario chains: impact, risk, rollback, communication	Knows when to stop, document and escalate.

Current operating constraints

Treat the current position as a Level 1 support boundary, two DCS days per week, with complex deployments or production changes sitting with Paul/Adam unless assigned. The aim is not to force advancement; it is to grow steadily and make that growth verifiable.

Device context matters

The DCS device map makes the learning concrete: old laptop trolleys, mixed Windows desktops, high-end Room 36 desktops, iPads, classroom displays/ViewBoards, Wi-Fi, ethernet, printers, charging, peripherals and classroom-pressure incidents. That is why the best PD is not generic - it must be re-stated as DCS scenarios.

3. Current skill picture

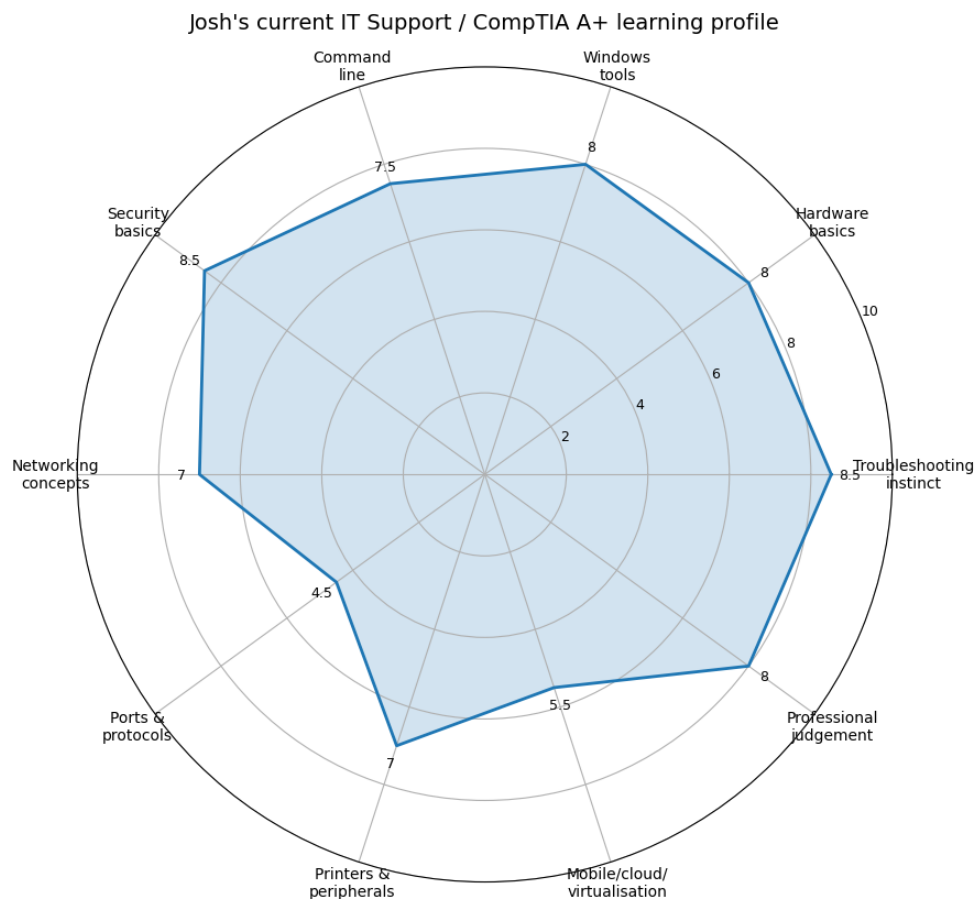
what the graphs actually mean

Summary of the three graphs

The graphs are useful, but they must be treated as **early estimates**. They are strong for A+ style recall and practical support instincts, but less reliable for Level 2 and IT Manager readiness because whole domains have not yet been tested with high-enough rigour.

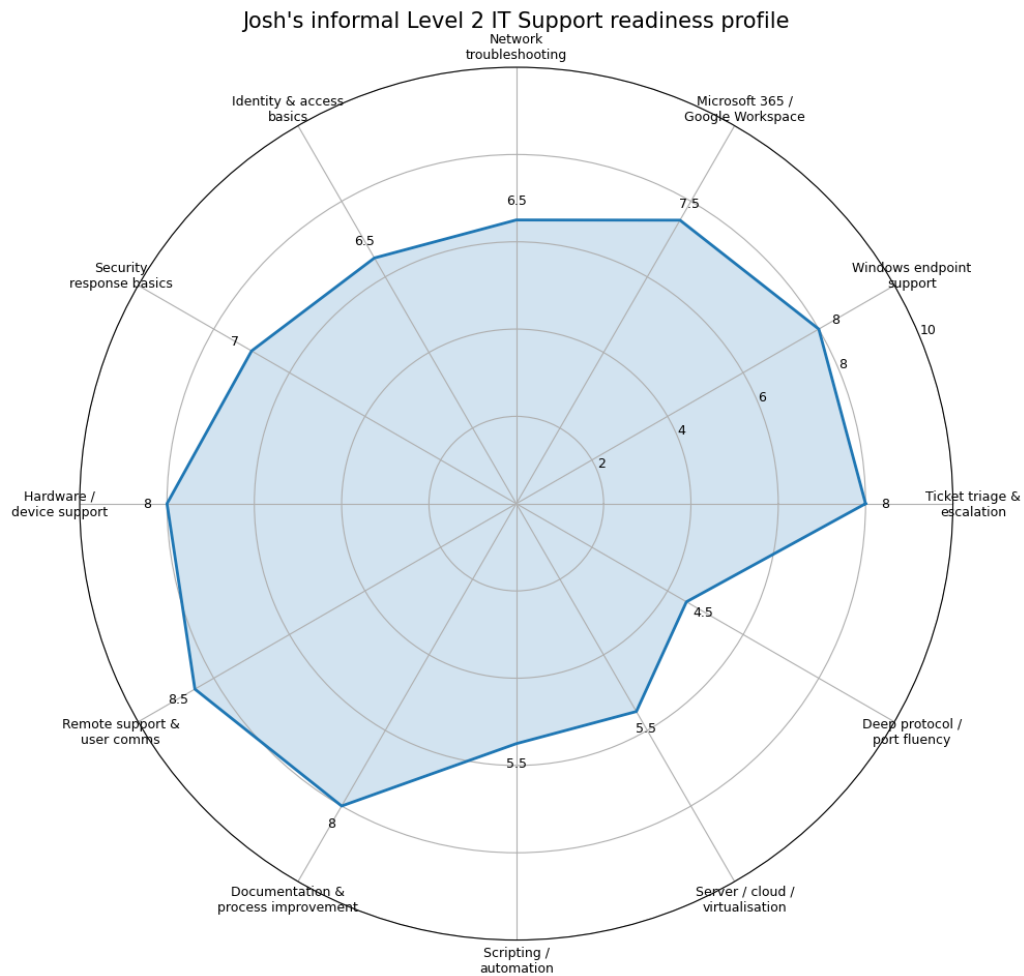
Domain	Current signal	Interpretation
A+ / L1 support	Strong practical answers in hardware, Windows tools, security and support basics	Good base for helpdesk and school endpoint support.
Level 2 support	Good user comms and endpoint instincts; weak deeper protocol, server/cloud, scripting and identity details	Emerging L2, not yet proven under scenario load.
School IT manager	Strong training/process/documentation instinct; weaker risk, governance, budget, network infrastructure and vendor management evidence	Future pathway, not current claim.

Graph 1 - CompTIA A+ / IT Support profile



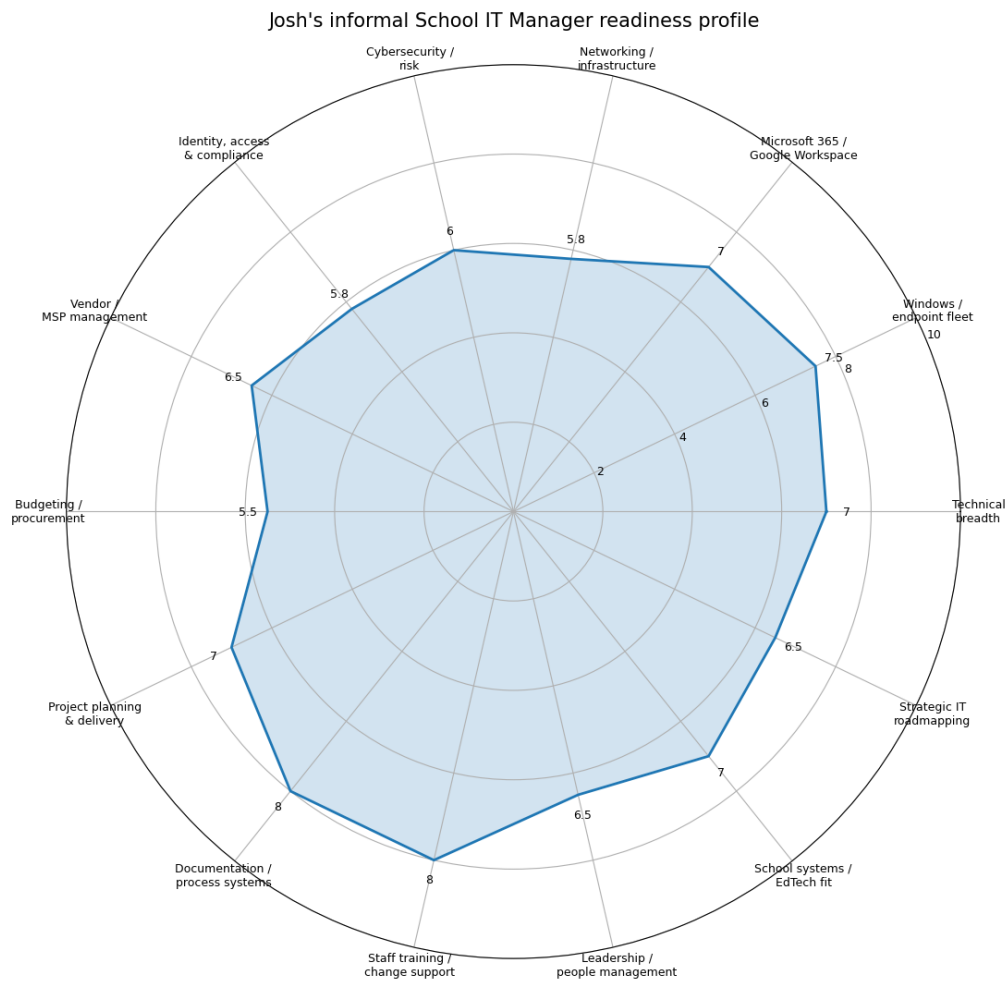
Main reading: strong practical support and Windows/hardware/security instincts; weakest early spoke is ports/protocols, with mobile/cloud/virtualisation under-tested.

Graph 2 - Level 2 IT Support readiness



Main reading: strong in user communication, Windows endpoints, hardware/device support and documentation. Gaps: deep protocols, server/cloud/virtualisation, scripting, and identity/access.

Graph 3 - School IT Manager readiness



Main reading: a promising support-and-systems builder profile, but not yet proven in risk ownership, budgeting, network/infrastructure leadership, governance, vendor management or strategic roadmapping.

4. Josh as a learner

how teachers should teach him

The learning design must fit the nervous system

Josh learns best when a concept is tied to real devices, real rooms, real users and real consequences. He can go very deep when interested, but passive, abstract or overly broad study will either drift or turn into over-research. The teacher's job is to create tight loops: concept, scenario, answer, feedback, correction, re-test.

Josh needs...	Why	Teacher action
Clear target per session	Reduces ADHD drift and open-ended over-study	Start with: "By the end of 25 minutes you will be able to..."
Contextual anchors	Autism/ADHD learning improves when the pattern has real-world meaning	Use DCS rooms, devices, tickets, ViewBoards, iPads, printers and staff scenarios.
Strict but kind marking	Prevents false confidence while keeping engagement safe	Score answer, reasoning and risk separately. No free marks for lucky guesses.
Short cycles	Maintains energy and attention	20-35 minute blocks: learn, retrieve, apply, log.
Spaced repetition	Stops "I got it today" becoming false mastery	Re-test misses after 1 day, 1 week, 3 weeks and 6 weeks.
Embodied reset	Anxiety can reduce reasoning quality	Before hard scenario: breathe, feet on floor, slow down, then answer.

Teacher warning

Do not praise vague answers as mastery. Josh responds well to warmth, but he also needs rigour. The safest tone is: "Good instinct. Now explain the mechanism. What risk would you check?"

Best answer format for Josh

Step	Prompt	Purpose
1	Confidence: 1 low, 2 medium, 3 high	Separates knowing from guessing.
2	Answer or plan	Captures the first decision.
3	Reasoning / mechanism	Shows actual understanding.
4	Risk / trade-off / what I would check	Moves toward Level 2 and manager thinking.

5. The 10-model learning stack

what to use and how

Use all 10, but with a backbone

The uploaded education-model work correctly identifies that retrieval practice, spaced practice and feedback should be the spine. The rest of the models should be layered around them so Josh is not merely watching videos but building transferable IT judgement.

Model	Josh-specific use	DCS example
1. Retrieval practice	Every session ends with closed-book recall.	After DNS video: explain IP vs DNS vs DHCP without notes.
2. Spaced practice	Re-test weak topics later, not just immediately.	Revisit ports at Q12, Q22, Q35, Q48 and next month.
3. Feedback/AfL	Immediate, specific, criterion-based feedback.	"Good answer, but your DNS explanation confused IP allocation."
4. Mastery learning	Do not move ahead until a domain reaches 80% with explanation.	Core 1 networking must hit 80% before Core 2 becomes the main focus.
5. Deliberate practice	Attack one weak subskill at a time.	Write 10 firewall allow/block rules until source/destination logic is automatic.
6. Worked examples + fading	Show a model answer, then remove scaffolds gradually.	First offboarding scenario with checklist, later no checklist.
7. Problem-based learning	Use realistic tickets rather than isolated facts.	"Teacher says internet is down in Room 36" multi-turn case.
8. Contextual/situated learning	Every topic must be translated into DCS terms.	Subnetting becomes staff/student/guest/printer VLANs, not abstract numbers.
9. Interleaving	Mix topics so Josh learns discrimination.	One block: printer fault, cloud model, DNS symptom, MDM policy.
10. Metacognition/self-explanation	Josh predicts confidence and explains why.	"I chose DaaS because user gets a cloud desktop; IaaS is just a server."

Most important implementation rule

Every PD block must create one of these: a recall answer, scenario answer, DCS note, error-log entry, glossary entry, checklist, escalation template, or safe staff-facing explanation. Watching alone does not count as finished learning.

6. Weekly operating system

how to run PD without overstepping

Thursday-Friday rhythm

This assumes the current 0.4 FTE / two-day pattern and the reality that tickets, calls, walk-ups, staff visibility and Paul's instructions always come first. PD is a use of genuine quiet windows, not a competing job.

When	Action	Output
Start of each day	Check Jira, email, phone/call flow and known staff needs. Walk the visible support line first.	PD does not begin until support is clear.
Quiet block 1 - 25 to 35 min	One focused lesson from A+, Cisco, or M365. No rabbit holes.	3 bullet notes + 1 DCS application.
Micro retrieval - 5 min	Close notes and answer 3 questions from memory.	Confidence score + errors.
Walk-around / visibility	Be available to staff and rooms; notice recurring friction.	Possible scenario bank entries.
Quiet block 2 - 20 to 30 min	Apply the concept to a DCS scenario or AI quiz.	Scenario answer marked by rubric.
End of Friday - 5 min	Update PD log and error log; choose next target.	Evidence trail and next learning step.

ADHD guardrail

Never start a vague block called "study networking". Start a small block called "DHCP vs DNS vs gateway - 25 minutes - write one DCS troubleshooting explanation".

The 25-minute block template

Minute	Action
0-2	Set target and confidence: "I am learning X so I can support Y at DCS."
2-12	Learn: one video/lesson section only.
12-18	Retrieve: close notes, explain from memory.
18-23	Apply: DCS scenario, ticket template, checklist or mini diagram.
23-25	Log: what I learned, DCS relevance, weak point, next review date.

7. Roadmap

12 weeks to one year

First 12-week sprint

Weeks	Primary focus	Mastery check	Evidence
1-2	Set up PD log; A+ Core 1 overview; laptop/mobile basics; DCS device map skim.	Explain A+ domains and identify 5 DCS device risks.	6 log entries minimum.
3-4	Networking basics: IP, DNS, DHCP, gateway, ports, cabling, Wi-Fi.	Explain DNS vs DHCP vs gateway; pass mixed ports scenario at 80%.	Network glossary v1.
5-6	Hardware: RAM, SSD/HDD, printers, displays, power, overheating.	Diagnose 8 mixed hardware/printer symptoms with explanations.	Hardware fault matrix.
7-8	Cloud/virtualisation and M365 concepts: SaaS/PaaS/IaaS/DaaS, Entra, Teams, OneDrive.	Correctly choose cloud models and explain offboarding sequence.	M365 object map v1.
9-10	Troubleshooting methodology and ticket writing.	Run one multi-turn scenario end to end.	Escalation note template.
11-12	Core 1 consolidation; start Cisco Networking Basics.	80%+ on mixed Core 1 quiz with explanation/risk.	One-page Core 1 progress summary.

Six-month and twelve-month path

Period	Focus	Minimum evidence
May-Jun 2026	A+ Core 1 first pass	8-12 log entries; laptop/network/hardware notes started.
Jul-Aug 2026	A+ Core 1 complete and Cisco Networking Basics started	Core 1 notes complete; NetAcad progress underway.
Sep-Oct 2026	A+ Core 2 first pass	OS, security and operational procedure notes.
Nov-Dec 2026	M365/AB-900 concepts	Study-guide map; MS-900 excluded as retired.
Jan-Feb 2027	Endpoint Security or Networking Devices	Cisco module progress or completion evidence.
Mar-Apr 2027	Review, evidence pack, decision point	One-page evidence summary with hours, modules, ticket relevance and suggested next PD.

8. Assessment architecture

how teachers should test Josh

Fix the weaknesses in the first 60 questions

The earlier quiz worked for engagement and basic recall, but it overused MCQ, accepted explanations too late, used easy distractors, and under-tested upper-Bloom skills. From now on, assessment must be mixed-format and scenario-heavy.

Rule	Implementation
Mandatory explanation	Every answer includes confidence, answer, reasoning and risk/trade-off.
No silly distractors	Wrong answers must be plausible within the same technical domain.
Strict rubric	0.3 answer, 0.4 reasoning, 0.3 judgement/risk. No full mark for lucky choice.
Scenario chains	At least one 4-6 turn case per 10 questions.
Upper-Bloom quota	Each block of 10 has at least 1 Analyse, 1 Evaluate and 1 Create task.
Spaced repetition	Previously missed concepts must reappear after spacing, not immediately only.
Error log	Every weak answer becomes a dated error item with a next review date.

Question mix per block of 10

Type	Count	Example
Recall / recognition	2	Which protocol sends email?
Mechanism explanation	2	Explain why ping IP works but ping name fails.
Practical scenario	2	Teacher has HDMI display but no audio. Walk the first checks.
Scenario chain	2	Internet down in Room 36; new findings are introduced over 5 turns.
Evaluate	1	Choose between VPN, DaaS and app streaming for students from home.
Create	1	Write a guest Wi-Fi firewall rule set in plain English.

Marking example

Answer: DaaS. Reasoning: users need a full Windows desktop from Chromebooks/BYOD; DaaS keeps apps/data in managed environment. Risk: licensing, performance, MFA, printing, and data controls must be checked. Score 1/1. If Josh only says "DaaS" with no reasoning, score 0.3/1.

9. DCS scenario bank

where learning should be situated

Use DCS-like cases, not generic trivia

These scenarios train transfer. They also help AI or human teachers assess Level 2 and IT-manager style judgement without requiring Josh to touch production systems.

Scenario	Domain	What to assess
Room 36 high-end desktops are slow after graphics driver updates.	Hardware/Windows/drivers	Rollback, Device Manager, Event Viewer, user impact, escalation.
Maths trolley laptops connect to Wi-Fi but some show 169.254 addresses.	Networking/DHCP	APIPA, DHCP scope, Wi-Fi, VLAN, access point, escalation facts.
Staff laptop on HDMI shows image but no sound.	Classroom AV	Windows sound output, display settings, cable/display volume, quick staff language.
Guest Wi-Fi must access internet only, not printers or staff devices.	VLAN/firewall	Source/destination allow-block rules.
Former staff member may still receive Teams messages.	Identity/M365	Block sign-in, revoke sessions, logs, MFA, group removal, cache vs access.
Inkjet missing lines and laser toner rubs off.	Printers	Distinguish printhead/nozzle vs fuser/drum/roller faults.
iPads need required apps, passcodes and remote wipe.	MDM/mobile	MDM capabilities, profiles, app deployment, managed data.
Senior students need Windows-only apps from home on Chromebooks.	Cloud/virtualisation	DaaS vs VPN vs IaaS, data risk, licensing, support load.
Multiple users lose access after a change.	Change management	Stop, scope, rollback, communicate, document, escalate.

Scenario-chain template

Turn	Teacher gives...	Josh must do...
1	User symptom only	Ask 3 clarifying questions and choose first safe check.
2	First finding	Update hypothesis; explain why one cause is more likely.
3	New conflicting clue	Avoid tunnel vision; test another layer.
4	Impact expands	Recognise escalation/change-management risk.
5	Resolution or escalation	Write ticket note with facts and next action.

10. Content map

what to learn in what order

Mastery gates by topic

This prevents the tempting pattern of jumping ahead when something feels familiar. Do not move a topic to "done" until Josh can explain it, apply it to a DCS scenario, and answer it again later.

Gate	Topic cluster	Mastery target
1	Ports/protocols	Instant recall plus scenario use: FTP 21, SSH 22, SMTP 25, DNS 53, DHCP 67/68, HTTP 80, POP3 110, IMAP 143, HTTPS 443, RDP 3389.
2	IP/DNS/DHCP/gateway	Can diagnose: local-only, no IP, name failure, internet failure, APIPA.
3	Printers	Can match symptom to likely subsystem: fuser, drum, toner, rollers, printhead/nozzles, driver/spooler.
4	Cloud models	Can distinguish SaaS, PaaS, IaaS and DaaS using responsibility split.
5	M365 identity/offboarding	Can sequence: confirm authority, block sign-in, reset, revoke sessions, MFA, data preservation, group removal, device recovery, log.
6	VLAN/firewall basics	Can write source/destination rules in plain English for staff/student/guest/printer networks.
7	Group Policy vs MDM	Can explain when to use AD/GPO, Intune/MDM, local settings, or manual support.
8	Operational judgement	Can say when to stop, document, escalate, communicate and avoid production changes.

Suggested mastery threshold

For factual A+ items: 85%+ with explanation. For Level 2 scenarios: 80%+ using the 0.3/0.4/0.3 rubric. For IT manager readiness: create/evaluate tasks must be included, not just MCQ.

11. Evidence pack

how Josh proves growth without making waves

Keep evidence boring, safe and useful

The evidence pack is not a demand for promotion. It is a quiet proof trail that shows faithful development, better support thinking and respect for the current boundary.

Evidence item	Record this	Do not record this
PD log	Date, minutes, resource, topic, what learned, DCS relevance, next step	Student/staff names, private ticket details, passwords, screenshots of confidential systems
Error log	Question, weak concept, corrected explanation, next review date	Sensitive system configurations
Scenario answers	Your reasoning, risks, escalation point	Claims that you changed production systems
Course progress	Module completion, certificate, screenshot if safe	Paid exam pressure or inflated claims
Checklist/SOP draft	Generic process and manager-safe wording	Unapproved internal architecture details in personal tools

Monthly evidence summary template

Field	Prompt
Month	e.g. May 2026
Hours logged	Total quiet-window PD hours
Resources used	A+, Cisco, Microsoft Learn, Endpoint Security, etc.
Concepts improved	DNS/DHCP/gateway; printer fuser/drum; DaaS vs IaaS; etc.
DCS relevance	Which room/device/support pattern this helps.
Evidence	Log entries, module progress, scenario scores, checklist draft.
Next focus	One narrow target for next month.

12. Trainer-the-trainer guide

instructions for AI and human teachers

Non-negotiables for anyone teaching Josh ICT

Do	Do not
Start with a learning intention and success criterion.	Start with vague "let's study networking" prompts.
Ask confidence before the answer.	Treat a correct letter as mastery.
Require mechanism and risk/trade-off.	Give full marks for shallow answers.
Use plausible same-domain distractors.	Use nonsense distractors like DNS in a printer hardware question.
Mix recall, scenario, analyse, evaluate and create.	Run 50 MCQs in a row.
Create an error log and spaced retest.	Drill a weak topic once then never return.
Re-state concepts in DCS terms.	Leave knowledge abstract and decontextualised.
Keep tone warm, direct and rigorous.	Over-praise or soften correction so much that it loses clarity.

AI tutor system prompt

Copy/paste prompt

You are Josh's strict-but-kind DCS ICT tutor. Teach for CompTIA A+, Level 1 school support, emerging Level 2 support and future school IT leadership. Use DCS-style scenarios. Always ask for confidence, answer, reasoning and risk/trade-off. Mark 0.3 answer, 0.4 reasoning, 0.3 judgement. Use plausible same-domain distractors only. Maintain an error log and revisit misses with spaced repetition. Every 10 questions, update strengths, gaps and the next learning target. Include at least one Analyse, one Evaluate and one Create task per 10-question block.

Human mentor script

15-minute session script

1) "What did you learn this week?" 2) "Show me one DCS situation where it applies." 3) "Explain the mechanism without notes." 4) "What could go wrong if you applied it badly?" 5) "What is one small next step that stays inside your current role boundary?"

13. Ready-to-use task bank

upper-Bloom and practical tasks

Use these to move beyond MCQ

Bloom level	Task
Understand	Explain DNS vs DHCP vs default gateway using a DCS classroom laptop example.
Apply	A laptop has 169.254.x.x in Room 20. Write your first five checks.
Analyse	Compare three causes of "internet down" when ping 8.8.8.8 works but websites fail.
Evaluate	Choose VPN, DaaS or local install for students using Windows-only apps from home; justify trade-offs.
Create	Design a plain-English VLAN/firewall rule set for staff, student, guest and printer networks.
Create	Write a safe offboarding checklist for a staff member with M365, OneDrive, Teams and a managed laptop.

Practical performance-based simulations

Simulation	Deliverable
No internet in classroom	Troubleshooting decision tree + escalation note.
Former staff account risk	Offboarding checklist with data preservation and session revocation.
Printer defect diagnosis	Fault matrix mapping symptoms to parts and first checks.
BYOD access design	Network access rules and risks for student-owned devices.
ViewBoard/laptop workflow	90-second staff-safe explanation or script.

14. Boundaries and risk

grow without overstepping

Where Josh must be careful

Risk	Why it matters	Safer path
Overstepping Level 1 boundary	Can reduce trust with Paul/Adam and create production risk.	Use sandboxes and ask before touching production.
Private notes with confidential details	School/student/staff data must stay protected.	Record concepts, not identities or sensitive configs.
Course collecting	ADHD curiosity can become too many resources and not enough mastery.	One main lane at a time: A+ then Cisco then M365.
False confidence from MCQ	A correct option can hide weak reasoning.	Require free-response mechanism and risk.
Hyperfocus on manager-level topics	May feel exciting but skip foundations.	Use manager topics as scenario practice, not current role claims.
Paid exams too early	Cost and pressure without enough evidence.	Do free learning first; ask later only if DCS sees value.

Faithful posture

This plan is not about grasping for status. It is about becoming more useful, calm, reliable and wise in the work God has put in front of you. The quiet path is not wasted if it produces competence, humility, service and trust.

15. Templates

copy into OneNote, Word or an AI chat

PD log template

Date	Minutes	Resource	Topic	What I learned	DCS relevance	Next step
Thu ___/___/___	30	A+ Core 1	DHCP/DNS	DHCP gives IP settings; DNS resolves names.	Useful when a laptop has local network but websites fail.	Retest in 3 days.
Fri ___/___/___	25	Cisco Networking	VLANs	VLANs segment; firewall rules control access.	Guest Wi-Fi should be internet-only.	Write rule set.

Error log template

Date	Question/topic	My error	Correct principle	Next review
___/___/___	DaaS vs IaaS	Chose IaaS for student cloud desktop	DaaS = user desktop; IaaS = server infrastructure	+7 days
___/___/___	DNS scenario	Said router did not give IP even though ping IP worked	If ping IP works but name fails, suspect DNS	+3 days

Escalation note template

Copy/paste

Issue: [brief symptom]

Who/where: [role/room/device type only, no unnecessary personal detail]

Scope: [one user / room / multiple users]

Checks tried: [numbered list]

Findings: [IP, gateway, error, logs, device state]

Risk/impact: [teaching blocked, security risk, data risk]

Request/next step: [what you need from L2/Paul/Adam]

16. Source basis

what this guide was built from

Uploaded DCS and learning documents used

Source	Used for
DCS IT Support Assistant Position Description	Role scope: endpoint PCs, tickets, support, documentation, staff training, change management.
DCS IT PD Roadmap v3 and PD Plan v3	0.4 FTE/two-day constraints, Level 1 boundary, free PD stack, 12-week sprint, guardrails and evidence pack.
10 highest-efficacy educational models.docx	Retrieval, spacing, feedback, mastery, contextual learning and the educational model stack.
Josh's A+ quiz history and graphs	Current skill estimates, weak areas and assessment-design corrections.
Assessor feedback screenshots/text	Need for strict marking, upper-Bloom tasks, scenario chains, spaced repetition and no lazy distractors.

External/current sources checked while preparing this guide

Source	Relevant detail
Microsoft Learn - AB-900 study guide	AB-900 covers Microsoft 365 services, security/identity/access, data protection/governance, Copilot and agents.
Microsoft Learn - MS-900 retirement page	MS-900 retired March 31, 2026, so it should not be the main plan.
CompTIA A+ official/Professor Messer course pages	A+ V15 220-1201/220-1202 are the current A+ learning backbone; Professor Messer courses are free and match the exam objectives.
Cisco Networking Academy	Networking Basics is a free, self-paced networking foundation suited to Josh's DCS gaps.

Final bottom line

The next version of Josh's learning should be less like "watch a course" and more like a flight simulator for school ICT support: learn the concept, retrieve it, apply it to a DCS room/device/user scenario, get strict feedback, log the error, revisit it later, and only then count it as learned.